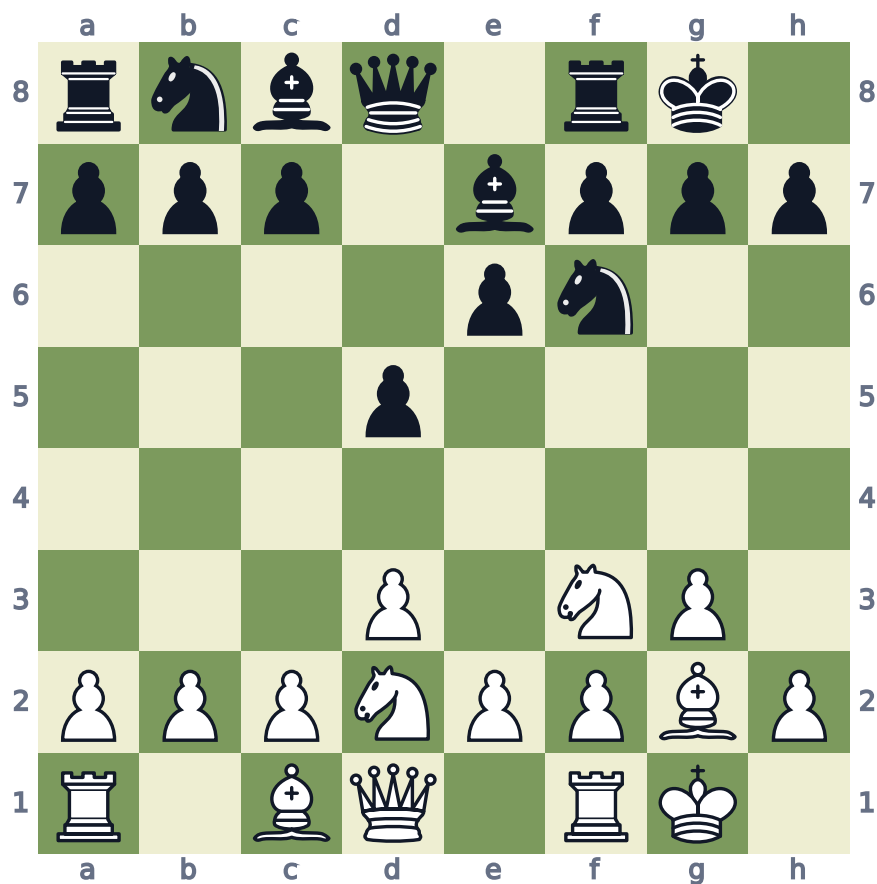


White Hippo Move Orders, Transpositions, and Exit Ramps

Starting with g3, Nf3, e3, or d3 and knowing when to abandon the shell



Reach the intended structures safely, avoid move-order traps, and recognize the exact moment a direct opening move is stronger than another setup move.

8 learning units | solid-piece diagrams | recall tests | engine checks

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Reach the intended structures safely, avoid move-order traps, and recognize the exact moment a direct opening move is stronger than another setup move.

THE WHITE HIPPO TRAINING LOOP

- Identify Black's center, both kings, and Black's most forcing pawn break.
- At every diagram compare e4, d4, c4, and f4 before choosing another setup move.
- Hide the answer until you have spoken the move, purpose, and Black's best reply.
- Replay each branch from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 8 units inside a connected 1.g3 repertoire. It teaches setup, exceptions, transformation, and resulting plans; the companion PGNs make later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

1.g3 preserves the most options but reveals the kingside fianchetto.

PRINCIPLE 2

Nf3 controls e5 but may block a planned f4.

PRINCIPLE 3

d3 supports e4; e3 supports d4 and frees the queen bishop.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

b3 must not uncover a1 to an unopposed g7 bishop.

PRINCIPLE 5

A forcing central advance can end the setup phase instantly.

PRINCIPLE 6

An exit ramp is a successful transformation, not a failure of the system.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 1-8

- | | | |
|-----------|------------------------------------|--|
| 01 | Nf3-first move order | Nf3 buys e5 control at the price of f-pawn freedom. |
| 02 | e3-first move order | e3-first points toward d4 more strongly than f4. |
| 03 | d3-first move order | d3-first announces e4; follow through before the center closes. |
| 04 | Safe b3 after c3 | Before b3, trace the entire diagonal to a1. |
| 05 | Exit ramp against early e4 | An early e4 ends the setup phase. |
| 06 | Exit ramp against early d4 | When d4 gains space, create a clear counterbreak before adding b3. |
| 07 | Exit into an open d-file | The shell is optional; take a favorable central exchange. |
| 08 | Exit into a Closed Sicilian | A good transposition is a successful White-Hippo decision. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 01

Nf3-first move order



COURSE LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6 4. d3 Be7 5. O-O O-O 6. Nbd2

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

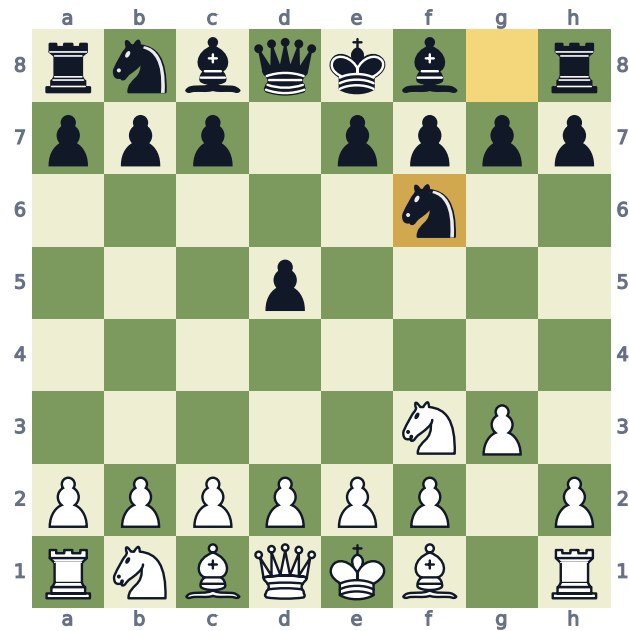
Use Nf3 to restrain e5, then enter a White-Hippo shell with faster castling.

MAIN DANGER

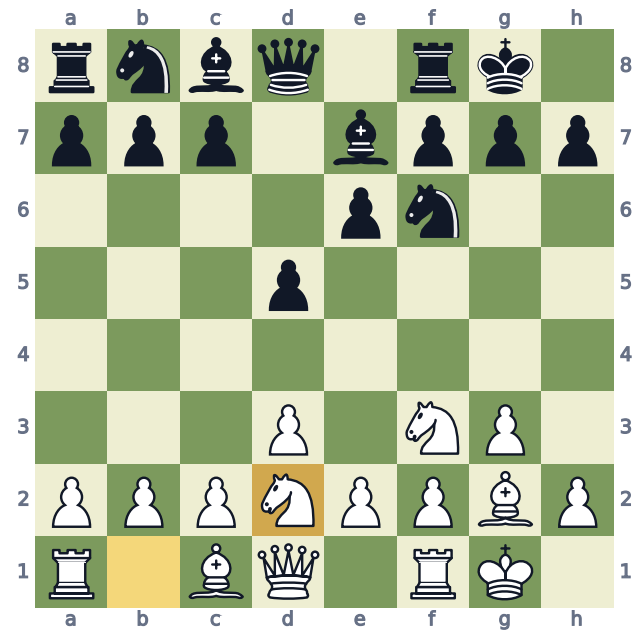
The knight blocks f4 and changes some attacking plans.

BRANCH LOGIC 01

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Nf3 buys e5 control at the price of f-pawn freedom.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.04 for White (equal). Principal continuation: 1. c5 Re1 2. Nc6 e4 3. Qc7 c3 4. dxe4 dxe4 5. e5 Nc4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 01

Nf3-first move order



YOUR TASK

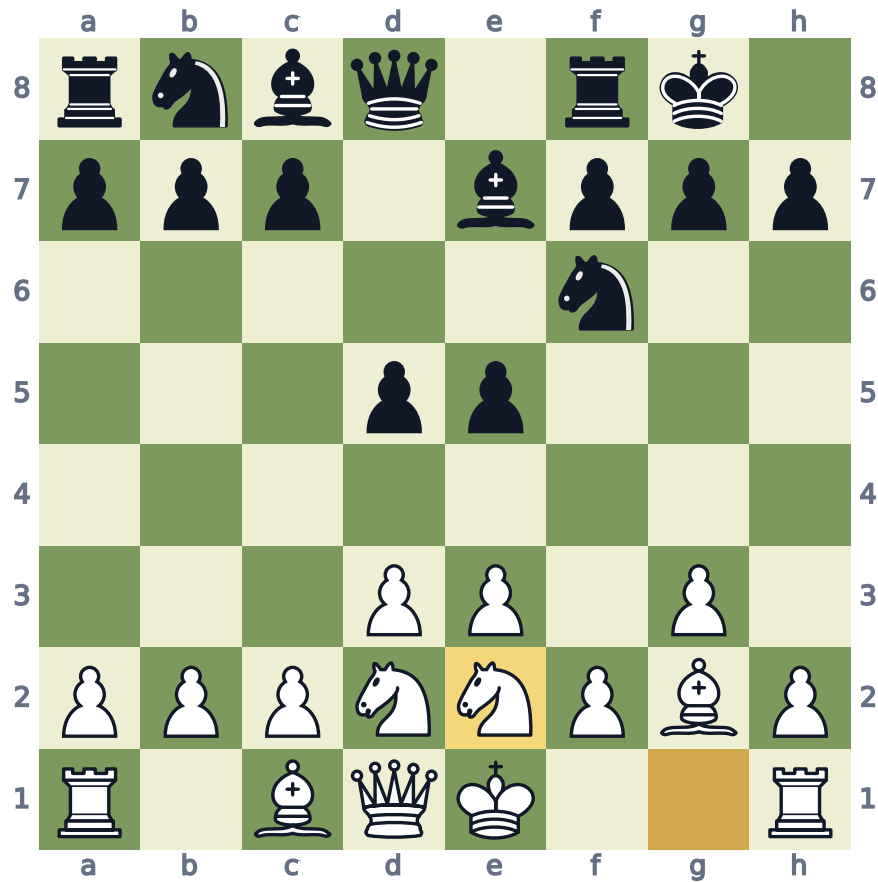
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 02

e3-first move order



COURSE LINE

1. e3 d5 2. g3 e5 3. Bg2 Nf6 4. d3 Be7 5. Nd2 O-O 6. Ne2

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

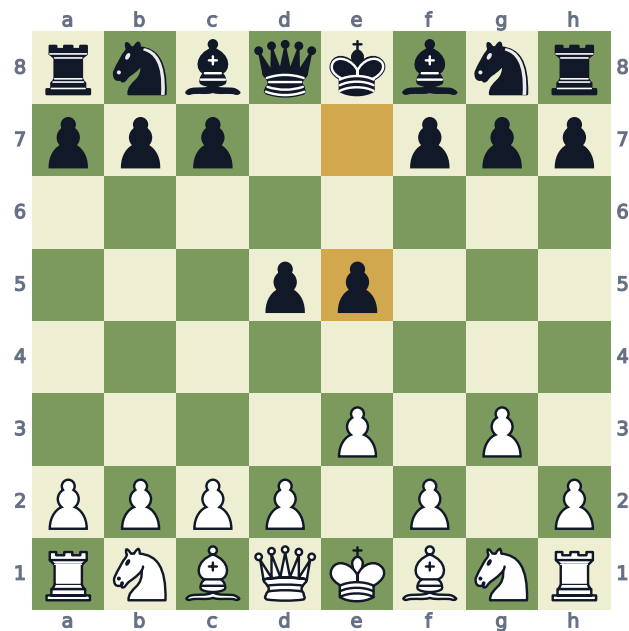
Use e3 to support d4 and free the queen bishop before fianchettoing.

MAIN DANGER

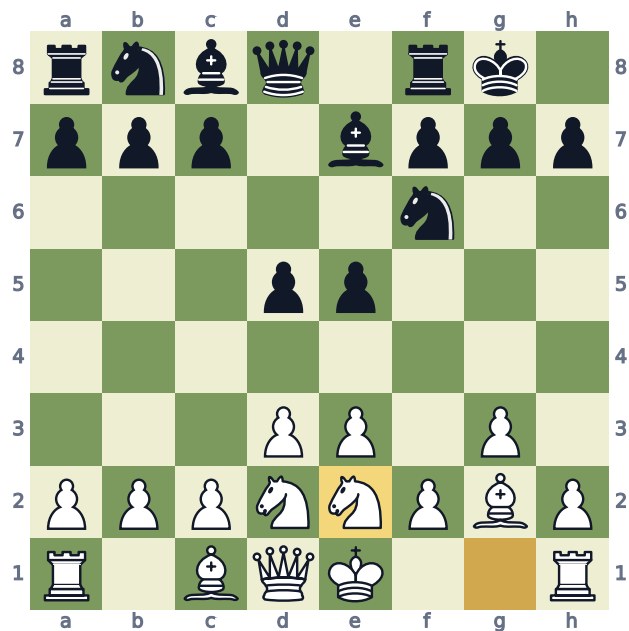
e4 can gain space before White completes development.

BRANCH LOGIC 02

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

e3-first points toward d4 more strongly than f4.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

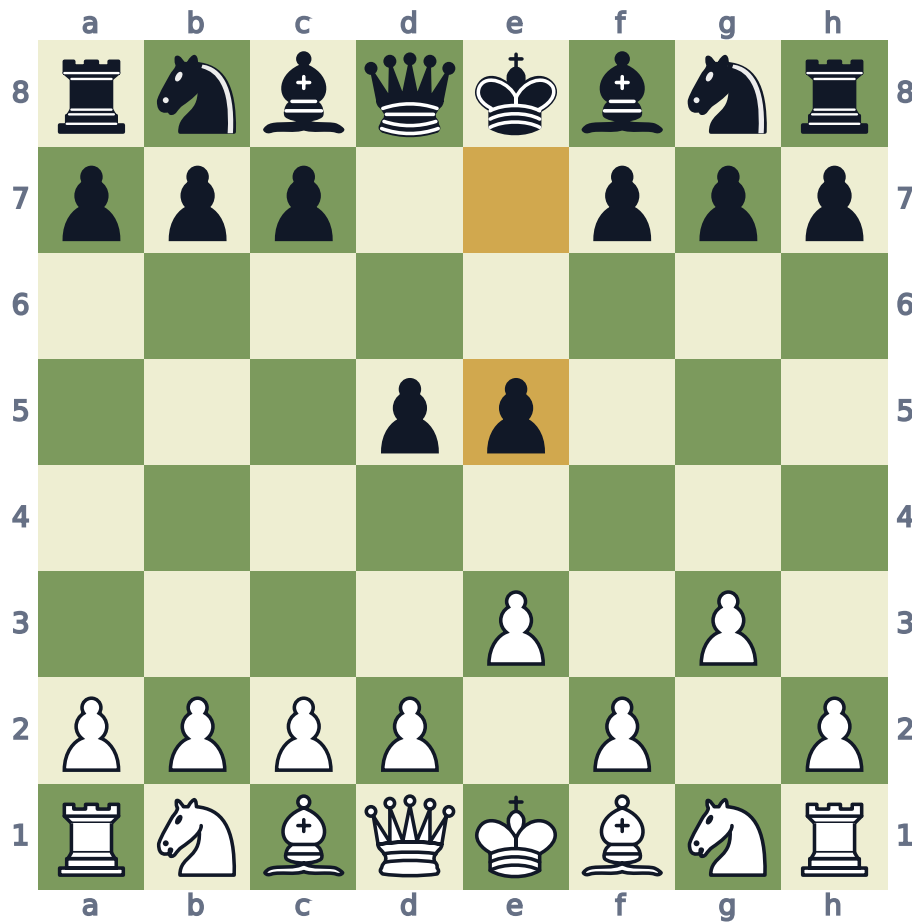
Position estimate: -0.64 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. c5 O-O 2. Nc6 d4 3. exd4 exd4 4. Re8 dxc5 5. Bxc5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 02

e3-first move order



YOUR TASK

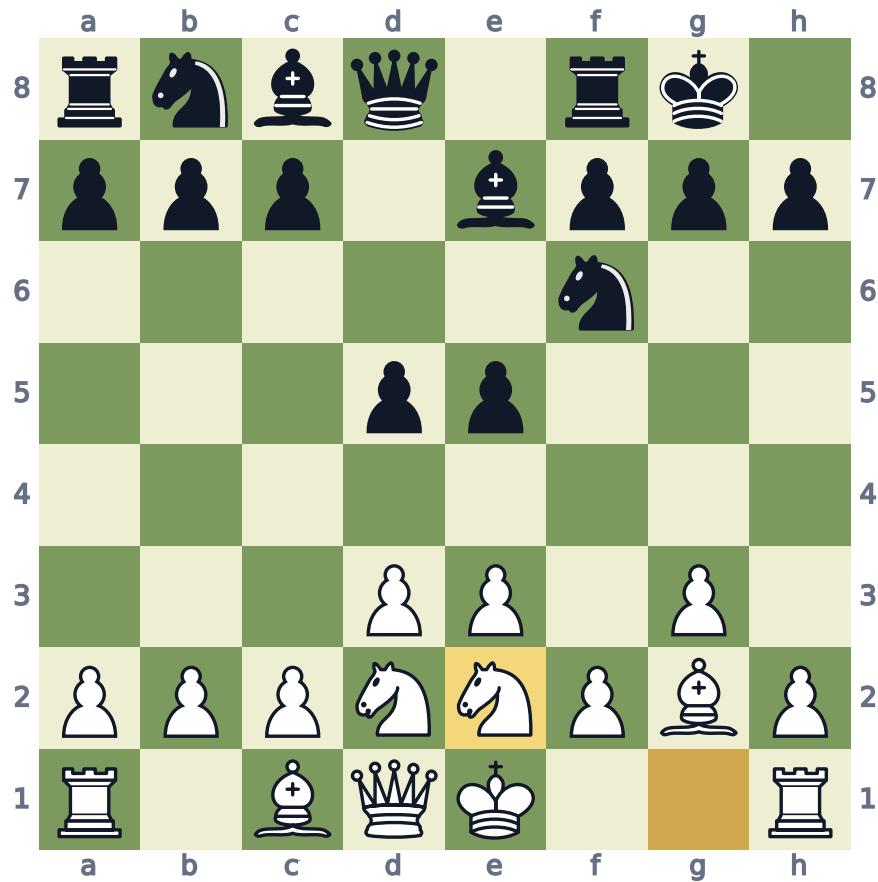
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 03

d3-first move order



COURSE LINE

1. d3 d5 2. g3 e5 3. Bg2 Nf6 4. Nd2 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

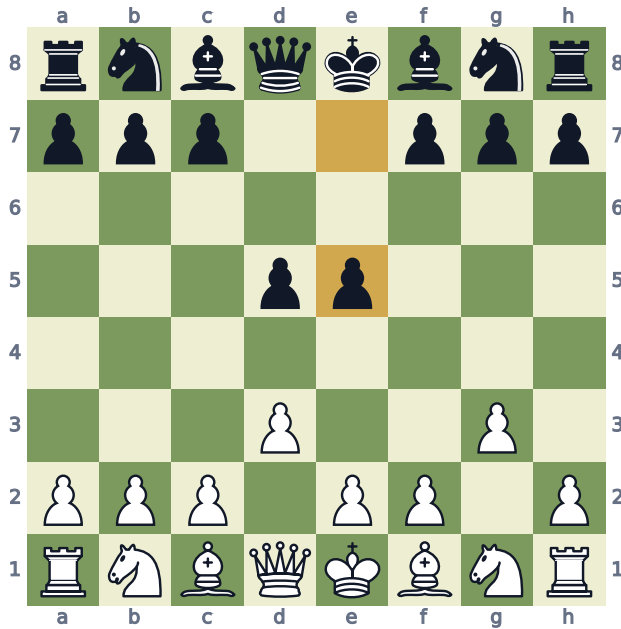
Support e4 immediately while preserving both knight choices.

MAIN DANGER

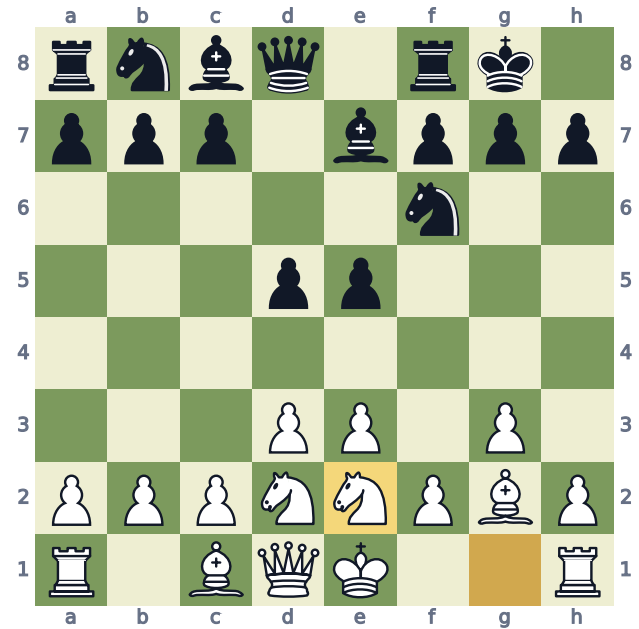
Black can use f5 before White castles.

BRANCH LOGIC 03

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

d3-first announces e4; follow through before the center closes.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

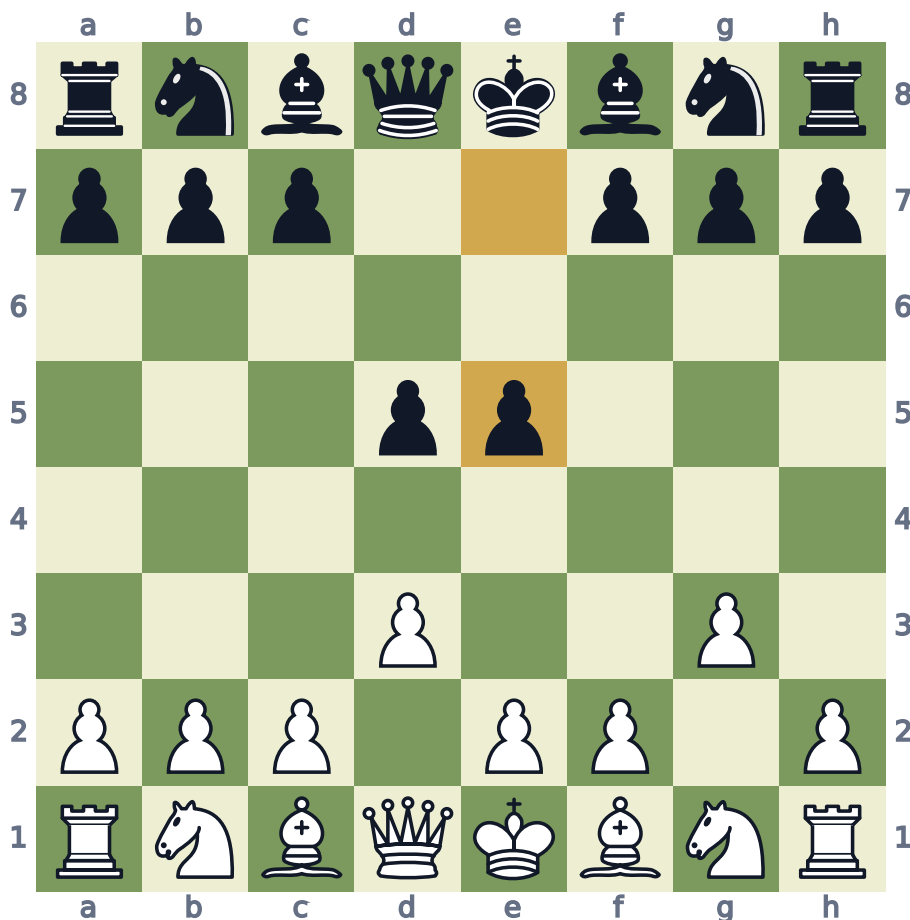
Position estimate: -0.59 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. c5 d4 2. exd4 exd4 3. Nc6 O-O 4. Re8 c3 5. h6 Nf3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 03

d3-first move order



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 04

Safe b3 after c3



COURSE LINE

1. g3 g6 2. Bg2 Bg7 3. d3 d6 4. Nd2 e5 5. e3 c5 6. c3 Nf6 7. b3

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

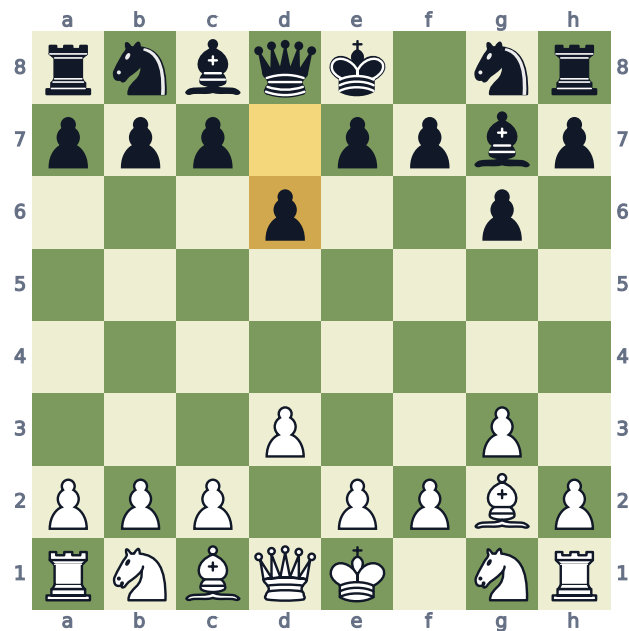
Close the g7-a1 diagonal with c3 before playing b3.

MAIN DANGER

d5 can still gain central space.

BRANCH LOGIC 04

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Before b3, trace the entire diagonal to a1.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

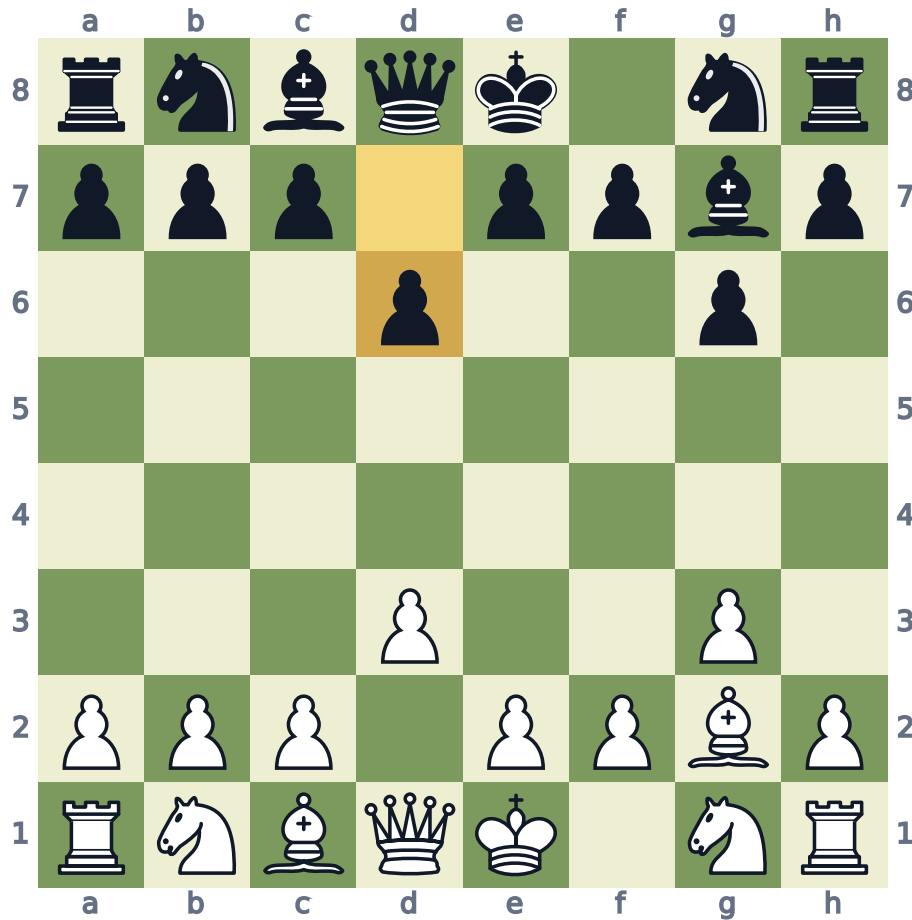
Position estimate: -0.62 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nc6 Ngf3 2. O-O e4 3. d5 O-O 4. b6 Bb2 5. Re8 exd5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 04

Safe b3 after c3



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 05

Exit ramp against early e4



COURSE LINE

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 e5 3. d3 e4 4. dxe4 dxe4 5. Nc3

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

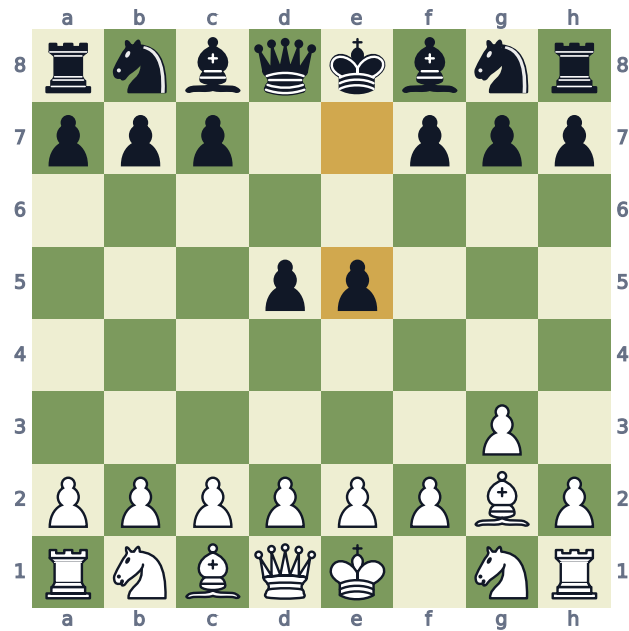
Resolve the advanced pawn and develop into an open center.

MAIN DANGER

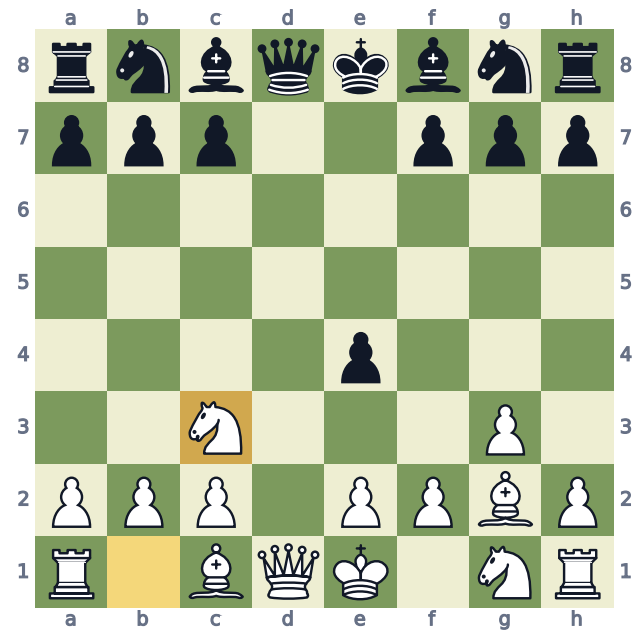
Black may use Qxd1+ ideas only if the d-file opens fully.

BRANCH LOGIC 05

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

An early e4 ends the setup phase.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

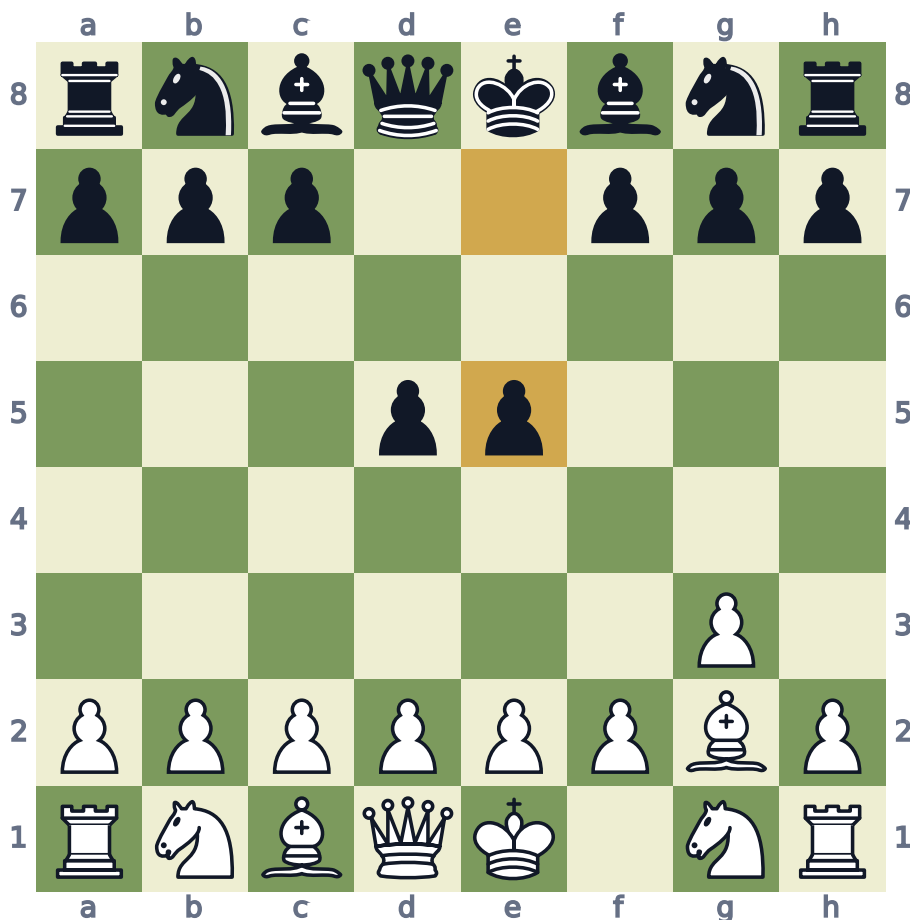
Position estimate: +0.81 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Qxd1+ Kxd1 2. Nf6 Nxe4 3. Nxe4 Bxe4 4. Bc5 Ke1 5. O-O Bf4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 05

Exit ramp against early e4



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 06

Exit ramp against early d4



COURSE LINE

1. g3 c5 2. Bg2 Nc6 3. d3 d5 4. Nd2 d4 5. e4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

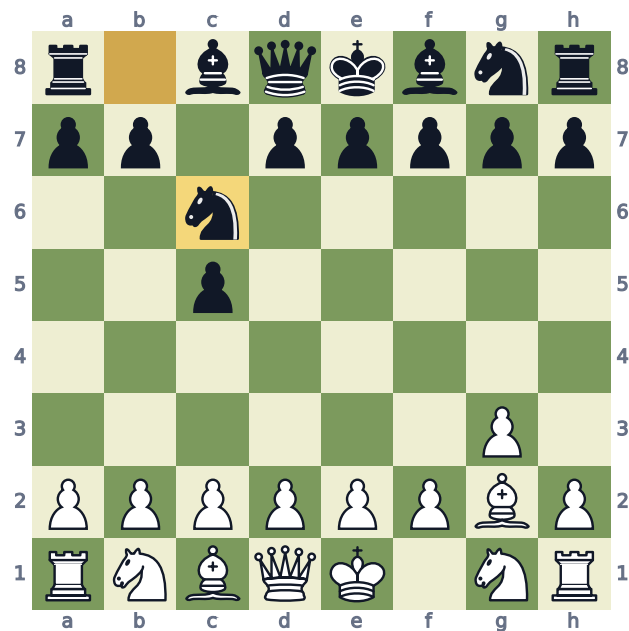
Fix the center with e4 and prepare f4 or c3 instead of completing the shell.

MAIN DANGER

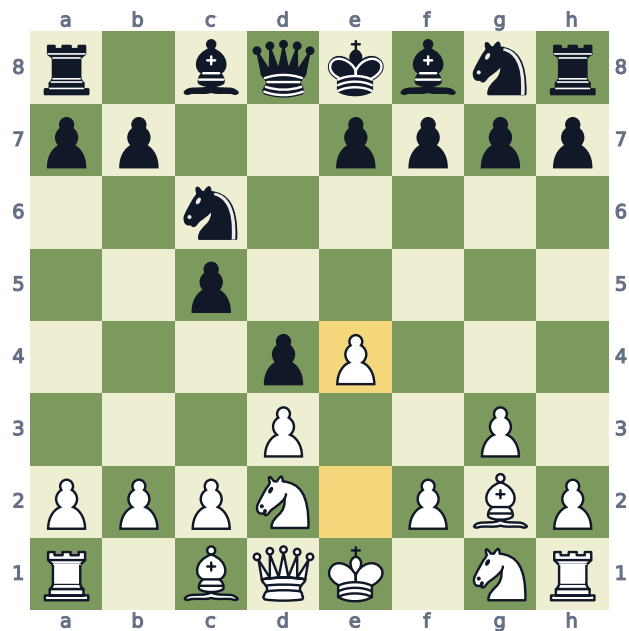
f5 can attack the closed chain quickly.

BRANCH LOGIC 06

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

When d4 gains space, create a clear counterbreak before adding b3.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

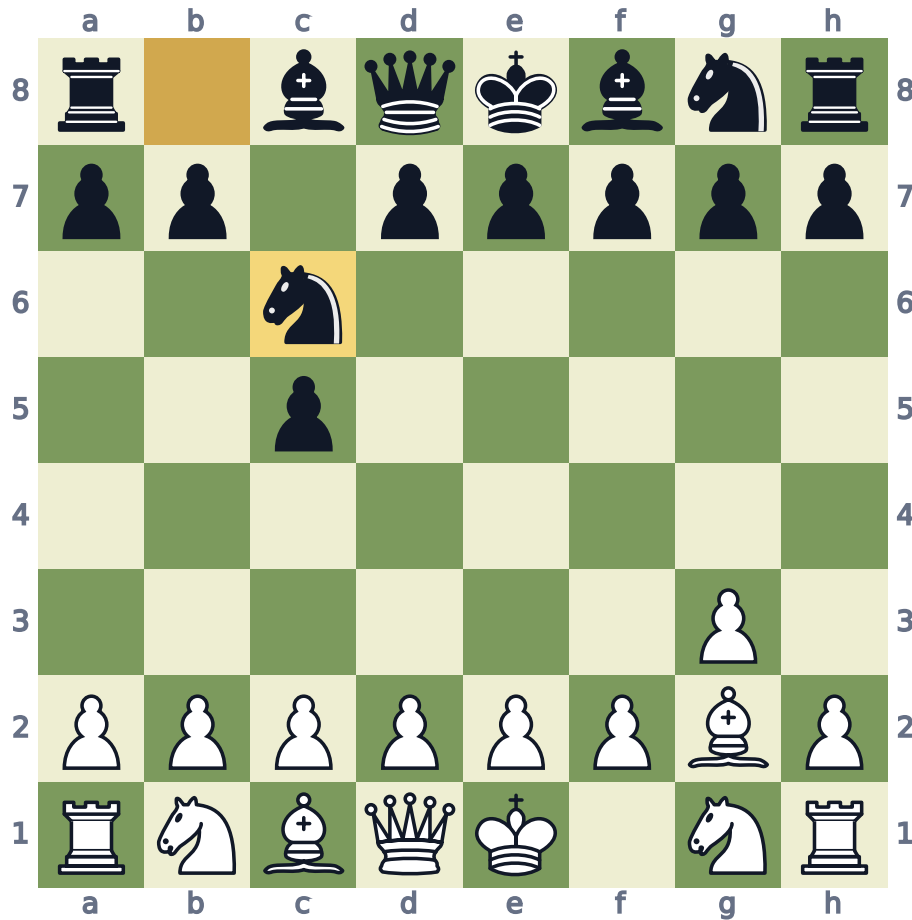
Position estimate: -0.28 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. e5 Qe2 2. Nf6 a4 3. Bd6 Nc4 4. Bc7 Bd2

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 06

Exit ramp against early d4



YOUR TASK

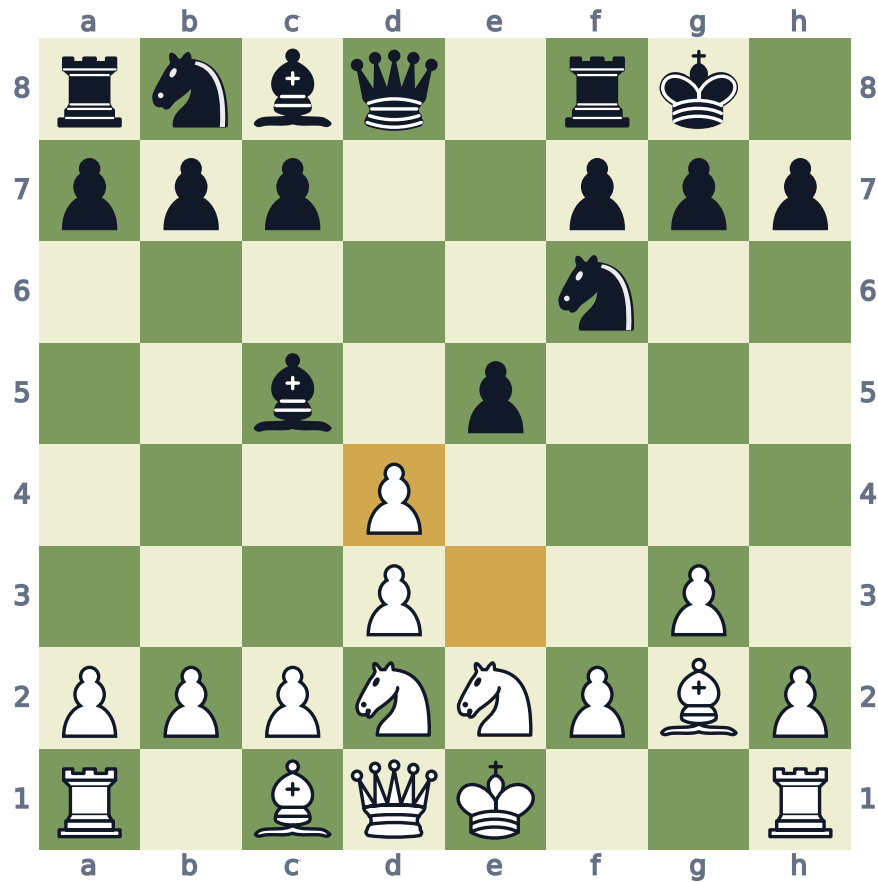
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 07

Exit into an open d-file



COURSE LINE

1. g3 e5 2. Bg2 Nf6 3. d3 d5 4. Nd2 Bc5 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 d4 7. exd4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

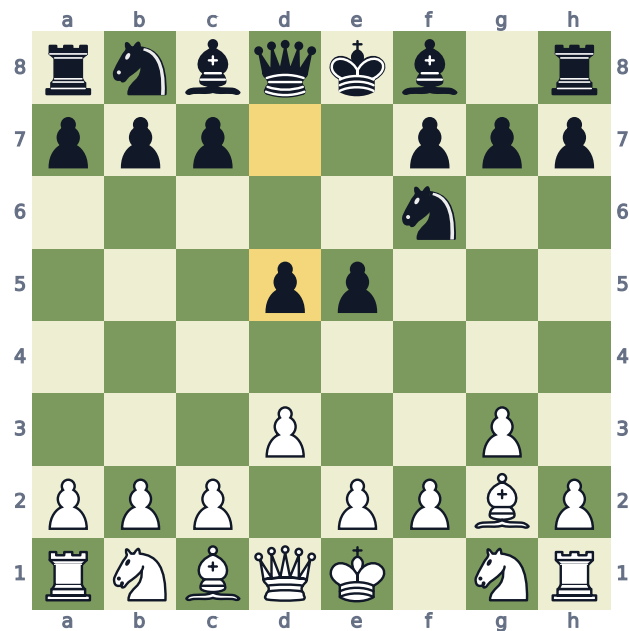
Open the center when exchanges improve development and expose Black's center.

MAIN DANGER

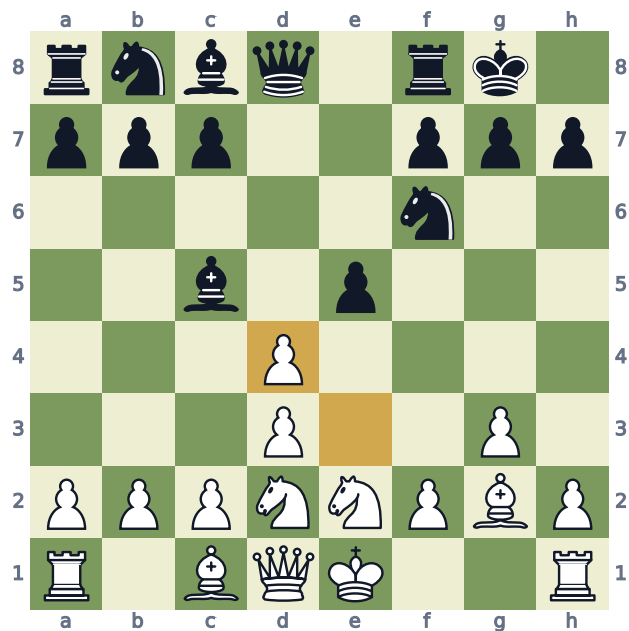
exd4 can leave White with an isolated or backward pawn.

BRANCH LOGIC 07

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

The shell is optional; take a favorable central exchange.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

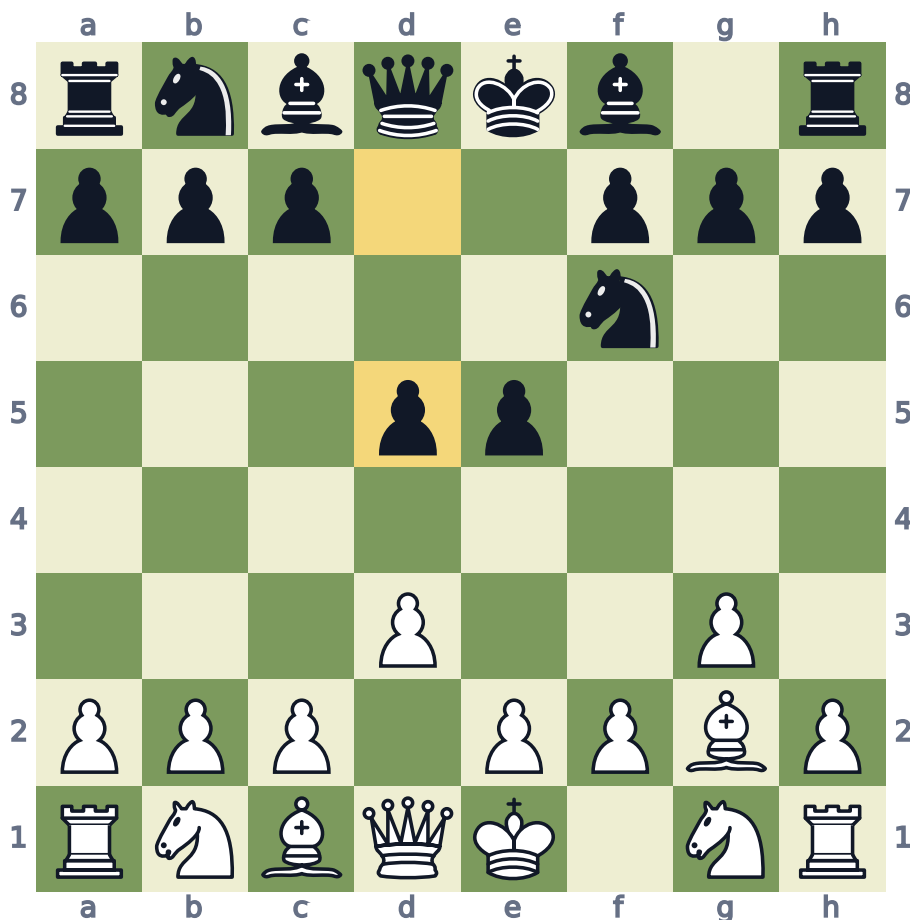
Position estimate: -0.01 for White (equal). Principal continuation: 1. exd4 O-O

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 07

Exit into an open d-file



YOUR TASK

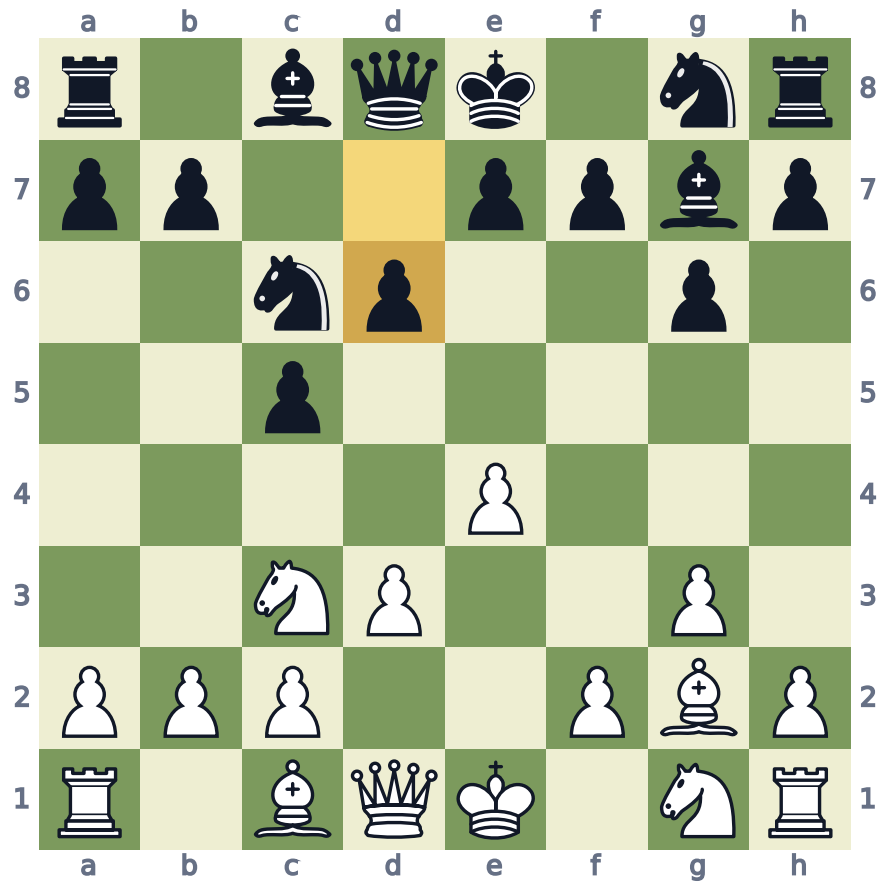
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 08

Exit into a Closed Sicilian



COURSE LINE

1. g3 c5 2. Bg2 Nc6 3. d3 g6 4. e4 Bg7 5. Nc3 d6

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

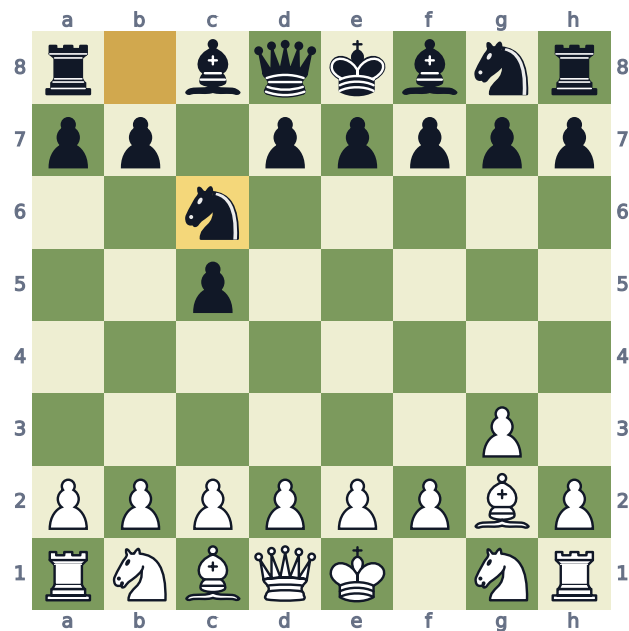
Choose e4 and Nc3 when the Closed Sicilian structure offers clearer plans.

MAIN DANGER

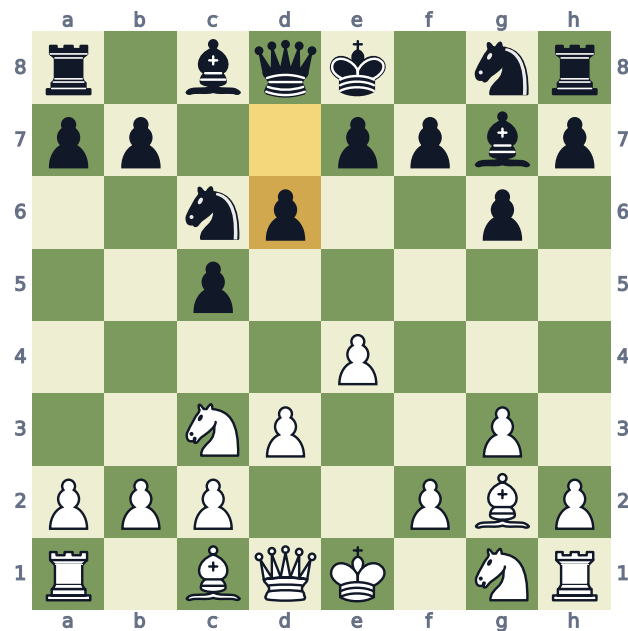
e5 or b5 can challenge the fixed center.

BRANCH LOGIC 08

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

A good transposition is a successful White-Hippo decision.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

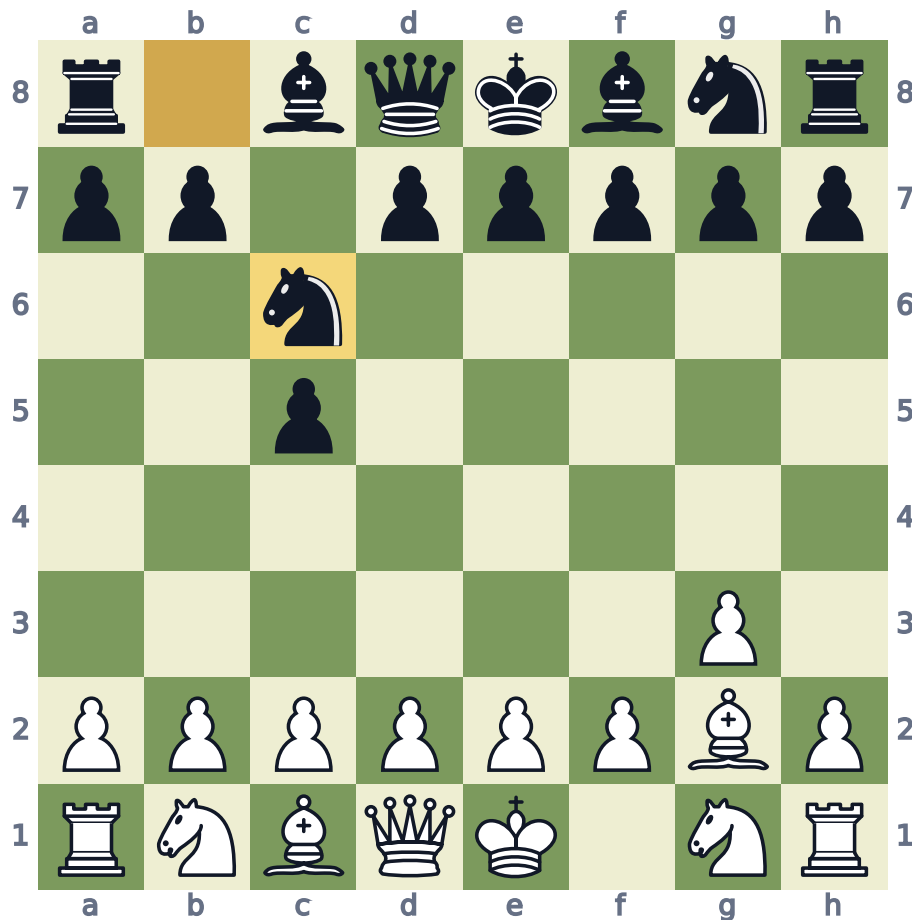
Position estimate: +0.02 for White (equal). Principal continuation: 1. Nge2 Nf6 2. O-O Rb8 3. Nd5 O-O 4. Nxf6+ Bxf6 5. c3 b5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 08

Exit into a Closed Sicilian



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

ANSWER SECTION

Recall solutions begin here

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not read a solution until you have committed to a move and purpose. A matching move without the correct reason earns partial credit. If the course move is not the engine's first choice, compare plans rather than treating the engine as a memorization oracle.

ERROR LABELS

M = move-order memory | T = tactical oversight | P = plan misunderstanding | V = visualization | C = calculation | R = rushed recognition

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce a question you can use in future games. Example: 'When Black supports d5 with c6, which pawn break or recovery method does my repertoire use?'

SOLUTIONS

Answers 1-3

01. NF3-FIRST MOVE ORDER

Course move: Bg2. Purpose: Use Nf3 to restrain e5, then enter a White-Hippo shell with faster castling. Engine comparison: 1. Bg2 g6 2. d4 Bg7 3. c4 c6 4. b3 O-O 5. Bb2 (+0.24 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The knight blocks f4 and changes some attacking plans.

02. E3-FIRST MOVE ORDER

Course move: Bg2. Purpose: Use e3 to support d4 and free the queen bishop before fianchettoing. Engine comparison: 1. d4 Nc6 2. dxe5 Nxe5 3. Nd2 Bd6 4. Ngf3 Nf6 5. Nxe5 Bxe5 (-0.56 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: e4 can gain space before White completes development.

03. D3-FIRST MOVE ORDER

Course move: Bg2. Purpose: Support e4 immediately while preserving both knight choices. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 Nc6 2. Bg2 Be6 3. c3 Nf6 4. O-O Bd6 (-0.28 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: Black can use f5 before White castles.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 4-6

04. SAFE B3 AFTER C3

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Close the g7-a1 diagonal with c3 before playing b3. Engine comparison: 1. c4 c5 2. e3 Nf6 3. Nc3 Nc6 4. Nge2 Rb8 5. Rb1 O-O (+0.24 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: d5 can still gain central space.

05. EXIT RAMP AGAINST EARLY E4

Course move: d3. Purpose: Resolve the advanced pawn and develop into an open center. Engine comparison: 1. d4 exd4 2. Nf3 Bb4+ 3. Nbd2 Be7 4. Nxd4 c5 5. Nb5 Nf6 (-0.18 for White (equal)). Warning: Black may use Qxd1+ ideas only if the d-file opens fully.

06. EXIT RAMP AGAINST EARLY D4

Course move: d3. Purpose: Fix the center with e4 and prepare f4 or c3 instead of completing the shell. Engine comparison: 1. c4 g6 2. Nc3 Bg7 3. Nf3 d6 4. O-O Nf6 5. d4 O-O (+0.29 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: f5 can attack the closed chain quickly.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 7-8

07. EXIT INTO AN OPEN D-FILE

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Open the center when exchanges improve development and expose Black's center. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 Bd6 2. O-O O-O 3. c4 c6 4. cxd5 cxd5 5. Bg5 Be6 (-0.23 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: exd4 can leave White with an isolated or backward pawn.

08. EXIT INTO A CLOSED SICILIAN

Course move: d3. Purpose: Choose e4 and Nc3 when the Closed Sicilian structure offers clearer plans. Engine comparison: 1. c4 g6 2. Nc3 Bg7 3. Nf3 d6 4. O-O Nf6 5. d4 O-O (+0.29 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: e5 or b5 can challenge the fixed center.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.